FT FollowThrough

The Junk Removal Playbook

What to say from the first call to the five-star review. Copy the lines, put them in your own words, and keep this on your phone.

1. The first call or message

Sound calm, understand the job, and book a next step. Ask:

- What's going: a few items, a room, a garage or a whole house?
- Is anything heavy, like concrete, dirt or a piano, or anything like paint, tires or TVs?
- Where is it: curbside, in the garage, or up the stairs?
- Is there a date it has to be gone by, like a closing or a move-out?

> "Thanks for calling [Business], this is [Name]. Tell me what needs to go and I'll see how we can help."

> "Can you text me photos of everything, including the corners? I can give you a price today and come Thursday morning or Saturday at 9. Which works better?"

2. Presenting the quote

- Quote by how much of the truck it fills, and give a firm price before you load.
- Say what's included: loading from inside, sweeping up, dump and item fees.
- Put in writing that extra items are priced per eighth of a truck, and set a weight limit for heavy loads.
- Ask what should be donated or kept, and offer to set it aside.

> "From the photos, this is about half a truck, so [price], loading and dump fees included. I'll confirm it when I see it, before we load anything. Thursday morning still works?"

3. The 7 objections junk haulers hear and what to say

Acknowledge it, ask a question, answer honestly, suggest a next step.

1. "The franchise down the road quoted less."
"Could be, and it's worth comparing. Was theirs a firm price or an estimate that changes once it's on the truck? Check whether it includes loading from inside, sweeping up and dump fees. I give a firm price before we load, and I'll put it in writing so you can set it next to theirs."

2. "I want a couple more quotes first."
"Of course. Will they quote from photos or come out? Make sure each one includes loading, disposal and item fees, because that's where totals change. I can hold Thursday morning for you until Wednesday night."

3. "I need to check with my siblings, it's Mom's house."
"Of course, that's a lot to decide together. Is there anything they'll want to keep or donate? I'll send photos of each room with a price, and set aside anything you mark so nobody's surprised."

4. "I'll just rent a dumpster."
"That works for some projects. How much of it are you planning to load yourself? A dumpster can need a street permit, sits in your driveway for days and has weight limits and banned items. We load everything in one visit and sweep up. Want both prices side by side?"

5. “I’ll deal with it after the holidays.”
“Understood. Is there a date it has to be gone by, like a closing or a move-out? End-of-month dates fill fast, and a full garage only gets fuller. I can take the heavy pieces now and come back for the rest when you’re ready.”

6. “How do I know you won’t dump it in the woods?”
“Good question to ask, because illegal dumping can be traced back to you. Is there anything you’d like donated or recycled? I’ll text you the dump receipt and any donation receipt after the job.”

7. “Do I pay before or after you load?”
“After, and that’s a fair thing to ask. We confirm the final price once it’s on the truck and before we leave, so you see what you’re paying for. For jobs that take more than a day, I ask for a deposit to cover the first dump runs, and it’s all on the written quote.”

4. Follow up: day 2, day 5, day 12

Most quotes go quiet, not “no”. Keep each message short and useful.

> **Day 2:** “Hi [Name], it’s [Your name] from [Business]. Did the price come through okay? Happy to answer any questions.”

> **Day 5:** “Hi [Name], I’ll be in your area on [day] with room on the truck. Want me to take care of it then?”

> **Day 12:** “Hi [Name], I’ll close out your quote on Friday. If your date is getting close, reply and I’ll fit you in.”

Estates and move-outs run on deadlines. The hauler who calls back first usually gets the job.

5. Ask for the review and the referral

Ask when the space is empty and swept, when they’re happiest, and text a direct link to your Google review page.

> “Thanks again, [Name]. If you’re happy with how it went, would you leave a quick Google review? I’ll text you the link. And if a friend is moving or clearing out, I’d be glad to help.”

Realtors, property managers and estate sale companies need clean-outs every month. Send each one a short note after a job near them.

Three rules that keep you out of trouble

- Get commercial auto cover before your first paid load. A personal policy can deny a claim for a loaded truck.
- Know where paint, chemicals, tires and TVs can legally go before you take them, and keep a “won’t take” list.
- Quote from photos or a walkthrough, never from a call alone, and set a per-ton charge for heavy loads.

General education, not legal, tax or insurance advice. Rules and prices vary by state, so check yours.
The full start-up guide for junk haulers: followthroughguides.com/junk-removal · Questions: info@followthroughguides.com